(Assignment 2.2)

Part 1: Close Reading and Textual Analysis

• The Facts of Photography as an Art Process

Andrews explains that photography is a mechanical process involving a camera, lens, light, exposure, sensitive plates, chemicals, and printing. The photographer captures an image by controlling these technical elements. He also discusses techniques such as adjusting focus and managing light to produce different photographic effects (Andrews, 1892, pp. 2–5).

Andrews believes that art is more than technical skill or accurately copying what the eye sees. True art requires imagination, artistic feeling, thought selection, and the ability to express beauty. Its purpose is to transform ordinary subjects into meaningful pictures through the creator's personal judgment rather than simply recording facts (Andrews, 1892, pp. 7–8).

• The Character of the True Artist:

According to Andrews, an artist uses creativity, imagination, and personal judgment, while a routine operator mainly follows mechanical procedures. A true artist carefully studies the subject and makes decisions about composition, lighting, and atmosphere. Technical knowledge is important, but it cannot replace artistic feeling or the ability to recognize beauty (Andrews, 1892, pp. 5–8).

“Wait and watch” means photographers should patiently observe their subjects and wait for the right lighting, atmosphere, and moment. Andrews believes good photographs require careful timing instead of taking pictures without thought.

This practice shows that artistic work involves planning, patience, observation, and deliberate creative decisions (Andrews, 1892, p. 7).

- **Photography in Service of the Arts:**

Andrews explains that photography helps painters and illustrators by providing accurate references of people, places, objects, and details. It can also reproduce drawings and preserve original sketches. However, he believes photography should support painting and drawing rather than replace them because fine art requires imagination, creativity, and personal expression. He considers photography and painting related arts, each with its own strengths and limitations (Andrews, 1892, pp. 11–12, 14–17, 26–27).

Part 2: Critical Quote Analysis

Quote 1 (Page 8)

For Andrews, artistic feeling means recognizing beauty and making thoughtful choices about a subject, composition, light, and atmosphere. A camera may record an image, but the photographer's judgment gives it purpose and expression. This sensibility turns photography from routine operation into creative work. Andrews adds that artistic feeling should be educated through studying nature and master artists (p. 8).

Quote 2 (Page 12)

Emerson's alembic metaphor suggests that art transforms nature through the human mind, just as an alembic transforms material through distillation. Nature

supplies the starting point, but the artist adds imagination, emotion, selection, and judgment. Andrews uses the quotation to explain that painting does not merely copy appearances; it reshapes natural forms into an ideal expression (p. 12).

Quote 3 (Page 12)

Hamerton argues that photography records visible facts but lacks the selection and idealization he associates with fine art. For him, a fine art must do more than reproduce appearances; it must interpret and transform them. Andrews presents this criticism but calls it exaggerated. A photographer can use human choices in focus, lighting, composition, and printing (p. 12).

Part 3: The Family of the Arts and the Contemporary AI Controversy

• The Kinship of Media

I consider digital art a sister to traditional painting because both use creativity, imagination, composition, and color to express ideas. Generative AI can also belong to the family of fine arts when people guide the process and make creative decisions. The video case study shows that Allen used Midjourney to turn his imagination into Théâtre

D’opéra Spatial, demonstrating how technology can become a creative tool (Sky News Australia, 2022).

- **Evaluating the Colorado State Fair Verdict**

I think Allen's participation was fair because the competition rules did not clearly prohibit AI-generated artwork. According to the video case study, Allen's artwork won first place in the digital arts category, but his victory received criticism from artists who believed AI-generated images gave him an unfair advantage. Allen explained that he used creative prompts and spent over 80 hours developing the project, generating more than 900 images before selecting his final work. The fair's general manager also acknowledged that the controversy raised questions about future competition rules and possibly creating a separate AI art category (KOAA News5, 2022). I believe AI can be an authentic artistic tool when human creativity, effort, and judgment are involved.